

BUSINESS MEETING ETIQUETTE

OFFLINE BUSINESS MEETING

Preparation

Research: Know the meeting's agenda, participants, and objectives. Prepare your materials, questions, and contributions in advance.

Dress Appropriately: Adhere to the company's dress code or the standard for the meeting's context—usually business professional or business casual attire.

Arrive Early: Aim to arrive 5-10 minutes before the meeting starts to settle in and review your notes.

During the Meeting

Introductions: Offer a firm handshake, make eye contact, and introduce yourself clearly if there are new faces.
Active Participation: Engage actively but respectfully, listening attentively to others, and speaking clearly when it's your turn.

Note-Taking: Take notes on discussions, decisions, and any action items for which you're responsible.

Body Language: Maintain open, positive body language. Avoid checking your phone or other distractions.



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Concluding the Meeting

Summarize Contributions: Briefly recap your understandings or contributions if appropriate.

Action Items: Clarify any next steps, responsibilities, and deadlines before leaving.

Thank You: Thank the host or leader and any key participants personally before you leave.





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ONLINE BUSINESS MEETING

Technical Preparation

Software Familiarity: Ensure you're comfortable with the meeting platform (Zoom, Teams, etc.) before the meeting. Test your camera, microphone, and internet connection.

Environment: Choose a quiet, well-lit space. Your background should be professional and tidy.

During the Meeting

Video On: Turn your video on to foster a more engaged and personal connection, unless bandwidth is an issue.

Mute Yourself: Stay muted when not speaking to minimize background noise.

Stay Present: Avoid multitasking. Give the meeting your full attention to show respect to the speakers and content.

Speak Clearly: When it's your turn, speak clearly and pause occasionally for questions or comments. Use the platform's features (e.g., raise hand) to signal when you wish to speak.

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Concluding the Meeting

Recap Contributions: If leading, summarize the meeting's key points, decisions, and action items. As a participant, clarify any personal next steps.

Follow-Up: Send a follow-up email if you're the host, summarizing the meeting and outlining next steps. As a participant, respond promptly to any follow-up tasks.



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General Tips for Both Settings

Clarity and Conciseness: Whether speaking or writing, be clear and to the point. Time is valuable in business settings.

Respect and Professionalism: Treat all participants with respect, regardless of their role or opinion.

Confidentiality: Keep sensitive information discussed in the meeting confidential unless otherwise stated.

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